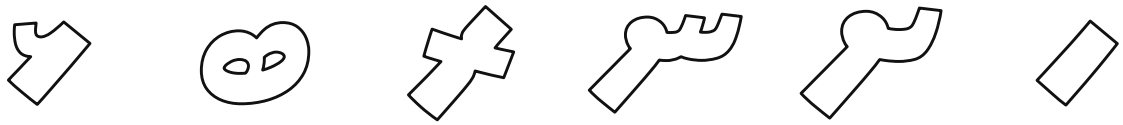
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 17

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Dhivehi Alphabet

ދިވެހި ފުރަތަމަ ބާވަރު ދަސްކުރާ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 24 Dhivehi Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Dhivehi Alphabet — ދިވެހި ފުރަތަމަ ބާކުރާ ގަނޑު

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 17

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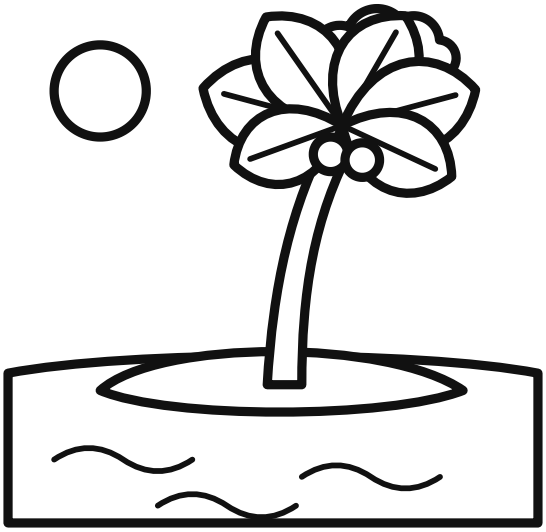
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

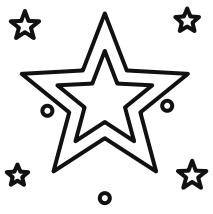
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

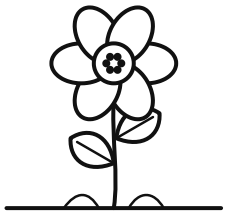


This book belongs to
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I started learning Dhivehi on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 17 is Dhivehi. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Dhivehi is read from right to left**, like the Qur'an. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon". Maldivians write long e and o as **ey** and **oa**: *vaarey* (rain), *dhoani* (boat).
- **dh** and **th** are a soft *d* and *t* with the tongue on the back of the teeth — never the English "th" of "the". Plain **d** and **t** are hard: curl the tongue back.
- **lh** is an *l* said with the tongue curled back: *valhu* (well).
- **nd, nb, ndh** in words like *handhu* (moon) and *anbu* (mango): say the *n* very lightly, gliding into the next sound.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Dhivehi name** written in Dhivehi (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. In Thaana the vowels are small signs called **fili**. The box marked *the letter with its fili* shows the letter wearing each of the ten fili, with the sound underneath: ◌ *ha*, ◌ *haa*, ◌ *hi*…

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the standard Dhivehi of Malé.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Dhivehi! ދިވެހި

dhivehi — the Dhivehi word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **340,000 people** speak Dhivehi, almost all of them in the Maldives.[3]

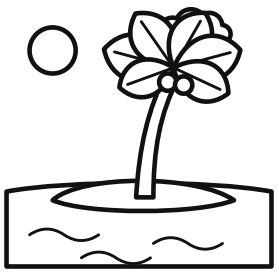
Where?
In the **Maldives**: about **1,200 small coral islands** in the Indian Ocean, in rings called **atolls**. The Maldives is a Muslim country, and island after island has its own mosque.

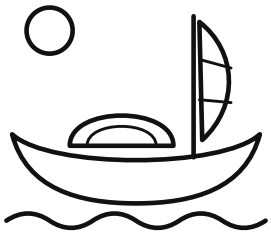
How is it written?
In **Thaana**, from **right to left**. The vowels are little strokes called **fili**, written above or below each letter.

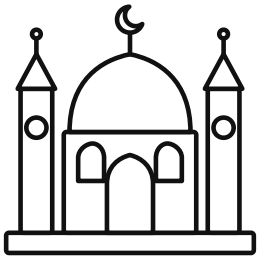
How many letters?
24 basic letters, plus dotted letters for Arabic words: ﷺ ﷻ ﷼ ﷽ ﷾ ﷿ ﷸ ﷹ ﷷ ﷵ ﷶ ﷴ ﷳ ﷲ ﷱ ﷰ ﷯ ﷮ ﷭ ﷬ ﷫ ﷪ ﷩ ﷨ ﷧ ﷦ ﷥ ﷤ ﷣ ﷢ ﷡ ﷠ ﷟ ﷞ ﷝ ﷜ ﷛ ﷚ ﷙ ﷘ ﷗ ﷖ ﷕ ﷔ ﷓ ﷒ ﷑ ﷐ ﶿ ﶾ ﶽ ﶼ ﶻ ﶺ ﶹ ﶸ ﶷ ﶶ ﶵ ﶴ ﶳ ﶲ ﶱ ﶰ ﶯ ﶮ ﶭ ﶬ ﶫ ﶪ ﶩ ﶨ ﶧ ﶦ ﶥ ﶤ ﶣ ﶢ ﶡ ﶠ ﶟ ﶞ ﶝ ﶜ ﶛ ﶚ ﶙ ﶘ ﶗ ﶖ ﶕ ﶔ ﶓ ﶒ ﶑ ﶐ ﵿ ﵾ ﵽ ﵼ ﵻ ﵺ ﵹ ﵸ ﵷ ﵶ ﵵ ﵴ ﵳ ﵲ ﵱ ﵰ ﵯ ﵮ ﵭ ﵬ ﵫ ﵪ ﵩ ﵨ ﵧ ﵦ ﵥ ﵤ ﵣ ﵢ ﵡ ﵠ ﵟ ﵞ ﵝ ﵜ ﵛ ﵚ ﵙ ﵘ ﵗ ﵖ ﵕ ﵔ ﵓ ﵒ ﵑ ﵐ ﴿ ﴾ ﴽ ﴼ ﴻ ﴺ ﴹ ﴸ ﴷ ﴶ ﴵ ﴴ ﴳ ﴲ ﴱ ﴰ ﴯ ﴮ ﴭ ﴬ ﴫ ﴪ ﴩ ﴨ ﴧ ﴦ ﴥ ﴤ ﴣ ﴢ ﴡ ﴠ ﴟ ﴞ ﴝ ﴜ ﴛ ﴚ ﴙ ﴘ ﴗ ﴖ ﴕ ﴔ ﴓ ﴒ ﴑ ﴐ ﳿ ﳾ ﳽ ﳼ ﳻ ﳺ ﳹ ﳸ ﳷ ﳶ ﳵ ﳴ ﳳ ﳲ ﳱ ﳰ ﳯ ﳮ ﳭ ﳬ ﳫ ﳪ ﳩ ﳨ ﳧ ﳦ ﳥ ﳤ ﳣ ﳢ ﳡ ﳠ ﳟ ﳞ ﳝ ﳜ ﳛ ﳚ ﳙ ﳘ ﳗ ﳖ ﳕ ﳔ ﳓ ﳒ ﳑ ﳐ ﲿ ﲾ ﲽ ﲼ ﲻ ﲺ ﲹ ﲸ ﲷ ﲶ ﲵ ﲴ ﲳ ﲲ ﲱ ﲰ ﲯ ﲮ ﲭ ﲬ ﲫ ﲪ ﲩ ﲨ ﲧ ﲦ ﲥ ﲤ ﲣ ﲢ ﲡ ﲠ ﲟ ﲞ ﲝ ﲜ ﲛ ﲚ ﲙ ﲘ ﲗ ﲖ ﲕ ﲔ ﲓ ﲒ ﲑ ﲐ ﱿ ﱾ ﱽ ﱼ ﱻ ﱺ ﱹ ﱸ ﱷ ﱶ ﱵ ﱴ ﱳ ﱲ ﱱ ﱰ ﱯ ﱮ ﱭ ﱬ ﱫ ﱪ ﱩ ﱨ ﱧ ﱦ ﱥ ﱤ ﱣ ﱢ ﱡ ﱠ ﱟ ﱞ ﱝ ﱜ ﱛ ﱚ ﱙ ﱘ ﱗ ﱖ ﱕ ﱔ ﱓ ﱒ ﱑ ﱐ ﰿ ﰾ ﰽ ﰼ ﰻ ﰺ ﰹ ﰸ ﰷ ﰶ ﰵ ﰴ ﰳ ﰲ ﰱ ﰰ ﰯ ﰮ ﰭ ﰬ ﰫ ﰪ ﰩ ﰨ ﰧ ﰦ ﰥ ﰤ ﰣ ﰢ ﰡ ﰠ ﰟ ﰞ ﰝ ﰜ ﰛ ﰚ ﰙ ﰘ ﰗ ﰖ ﰕ ﰔ ﰓ ﰒ ﰑ ﰐ ﯿ ﯾ ﯽ ﯼ ﯻ ﯺ ﯹ ﯸ ﯷ ﯶ ﯵ ﯴ ﯳ ﯲ ﯱ ﯰ ﯯ ﯮ ﯭ ﯬ ﯫ ﯪ ﯩ ﯨ ﯧ ﯦ ﯥ ﯤ ﯣ ﯢ ﯡ ﯠ ﯟ ﯞ ﯝ ﯜ ﯛ ﯚ ﯙ ﯘ ﯗ ﯖ ﯕ ﯔ ﯓ ﯒ ﯑ ﯐ ﮿ ﮾ ﮽ ﮼ ﮻ ﮺ ﮹ ﮸ ﮷ ﮶ ﮵ ﮴ ﮳ ﮲ ﮱ ﮰ ﮯ ﮮ ﮭ ﮬ ﮫ ﮪ ﮩ ﮨ ﮧ ﮦ ﮥ ﮤ ﮣ ﮢ ﮡ ﮠ ﮟ ﮞ ﮝ ﮜ ﮛ ﮚ ﮙ ﮘ ﮗ ﮖ ﮕ ﮔ ﮓ ﮒ ﮑ ﮐ ﭿ ﭾ ﭽ ﭼ ﭻ ﭺ ﭹ ﭸ ﭷ ﭶ ﭵ ﭴ ﭳ ﭲ ﭱ ﭰ ﭯ ﭮ ﭭ ﭬ ﭫ ﭪ ﭩ ﭨ ﭧ ﭦ ﭥ ﭤ ﭣ ﭢ ﭡ ﭠ ﭟ ﭞ ﭝ ﭜ ﭛ ﭚ ﭙ ﭘ ﭗ ﭖ ﭕ ﭔ ﭓ ﭒ ﭑ ﭐ ﬿ מּ ﬽ לּ כּ ךּ יּ טּ ﬷ זּ וּ הּ דּ גּ בּ אּ אָ אַ יִ ﬜ ﬛ ﬚ ﬙ ﬘ ﬗ ﬖ ﬕ ﬔ ﬓ ﬒ ﬑ ﬐ 﫿 﫾 﫽 﫼 﫻 﫺 﫹 﫸 﫷 﫶 﫵 﫴 﫳 﫲 﫱 﫰 﫯 﫮 﫭 﫬 﫫 﫪 﫩 﫨 﫧 﫦 﫥 﫤 﫣 﫢 﫡 﫠 﫟 﫞 﫝 﫜 﫛 﫚 龎 齃 𧻓 𥳐 𥉉 䀹 䀘 㮝 𣏕 𢡄 謹 諭 諾 謁 請 諸 調 視 覆 襁 蝹 華 荒 者 缾 練 絛 类 節 窱 磌 着 睊 直 盛 益 瘟 瘝 画 甆 瑱 猪 犯 爵 瞧 煮 瀞 漢 滋 滛 流 殺 歹 杖 望 朗 晴 敖 奔 奄 墳 塚 嗢 喙 啕 喝 勺 勇 冀 充 侀 全 况 並 﩯 﩮 舘 𤋮 恵 頻 響 難 逸 辶 贈 賓 謹 謁 視 褐 著 艹 艹 臭 者 署 繁 縉 練 節 突 穀 禎 禍 祝 祖 憎 慨 悔 屮 層 墨 塀 器 嘆 喝 卑 勤 勉 免 僧 侮 隷 郞 鶴 館 飼 飯 﨩 﨨 﨧 都 逸 﨤 﨣 諸 﨡 蘒 﨟 羽 精 靖 福 祥 神 礼 益 猪 凞 﨔 﨓 晴 﨑 塚 刺 茶 什 識 炙 狀 粒 笠 立 臨 淋 林 麟 鱗 隣 藺 璘 燐 吝 溺 匿 離 里 裡 裏 罹 痢 理 泥 梨 李 易 履 吏 利 隆 率 栗 慄 律 輪 淪 崙 倫 陸 戮 六 類 樂 料 尿 寮 僚 了 惡 隸 醴 禮 例 領 靈 零 鈴 聆 羚 瑩 玲 怜 嶺 寧 囹 令 獵 簾 殮 捻 念 廉 說 裂 烈 咽 劣 列 鍊 連 蓮 輦 聯 練 秊 璉 煉 漣 撚 戀 勵 量 諒 良 糧 梁 凉 兩 亮 略 掠 若 拾 沈 辰 殺 說 葉 省 塞 參 索 數 泌 不 復 便 磻 北 異 率 怒 寧 丹 諾 樂 拏 讀 陵 菱 綾 稜 凌 凜 肋 勒 陋 縷 錄 菉 綠 祿 碌 鷺 魯 露 路 虜 蘆 老 盧 爐 櫓 擄 勞 冷 來 郎 狼 浪 朗 廊 蠟 臘 拉 襤 藍 濫 嵐 鸞 蘭 爛 欄 卵 亂 駱 酪 落 珞 烙 洛 樂 邏 裸 螺 蘿                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 ￿ ￾ � ￼ ￻ ￺ ￹ ￸ ￷ ￶ ￵ ￴ ￳ ￲ ￱ ￰ ￯ ￮ ￭ ￬ ￫ ￪ ￩ ￨ ￧ ￦ ￥ ￤ ￣ ￢ ￡ ￠ ￟ ￞ ￝ ￜ ￛ ￚ ￙ ￘ ￗ ￖ ￕ ￔ ￓ ￒ ￑ ￐ ﾿ ﾾ ﾽ ﾼ ﾻ ﾺ ﾹ ﾸ ﾷ ﾶ ﾵ ﾴ ﾳ ﾲ ﾱ ﾰ ﾯ ﾮ ﾭ ﾬ ﾫ ﾪ ﾩ ﾨ ﾧ ﾦ ﾥ ﾤ ﾣ ﾢ ﾡ ﾠ ﾟ ﾞ ﾝ ﾜ ﾛ ﾚ ﾙ ﾘ ﾗ ﾖ ﾕ ﾔ ﾓ ﾒ ﾑ ﾐ ｿ ｾ ｽ ｼ ｻ ｺ ｹ ｸ ｷ ｶ ｵ ｴ ｳ ｲ ｱ ｰ ｯ ｮ ｭ ｬ ｫ ｪ ｩ ｨ ｧ ｦ ･ ､ ｣ ｢ ｡ ｠ ｟ ～ ｝ ｜ ｛ ｚ ｙ ｘ ｗ ｖ ｕ ｔ ｓ ｒ ｑ ｐ ＿ ＾ ］ ＼ ［ Ｚ Ｙ Ｘ Ｗ Ｖ Ｕ Ｔ Ｓ Ｒ Ｑ Ｐ Ｏ Ｎ Ｍ Ｌ Ｋ Ｊ Ｉ Ｈ Ｇ Ｆ Ｅ Ｄ Ｃ Ｂ Ａ ＠ ？ ＞ ＝ ＜ ； ： ９ ８ ７ ６ ５ ４ ３ ２ １ ０ ﻾ ﻽ ﻼ ﻻ ﻺ ﻹ ﻸ ﻷ ﻶ ﻵ ﻴ ﻳ ﻲ ﻱ ﻰ ﻯ ﻮ ﻭ ﻬ ﻫ ﻪ ﻩ ﻨ ﻧ ﻦ ﻥ ﻤ ﻣ ﻢ ﻡ ﻠ ﻟ ﻞ ﻝ ﻜ ﻛ ﻚ ﻙ ﻘ ﻗ ﻖ ﻕ ﻔ ﻓ ﻒ ﻑ ﻐ ﻏ ﻎ ﻍ ﻌ ﻋ ﻊ ﻉ ﻈ ﻇ ﻆ ﻅ ﻄ ﻃ ﻂ ﻁ ﻀ ﺿ ﺾ ﺽ ﺼ ﺻ ﺺ ﺹ ﺸ ﺷ ﺶ ﺵ ﺴ ﺳ ﺲ ﺱ ﺰ ﺯ ﺮ ﺭ ﺬ ﺫ ﺪ ﺩ ﺨ ﺧ ﺦ ﺥ ﺤ ﺣ ﺢ ﺡ ﺠ ﺟ ﺞ ﺝ ﺚ ﺙ ﺘ ﺗ ﺖ ﺕ ﺒ ﺑ ﺐ ﺏ ﺎ ﺍ ﺀ.

Letters from numbers!
The first nine letters, ١ to ٩, were made from the Arabic numerals 1–9, and the next nine from old Dhivehi numerals.

Letters on the map
The atolls have letter names in alphabet order, from north to south: Haa Alifu, Shaviyani, Noonu, Raa, Baa… all the way down to Seenu.







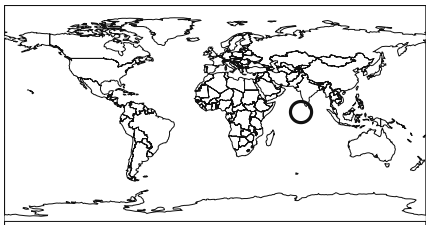
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Dhivehi Alphabet ދިވެހި

24 letters — ދިވެހި ތަނބުރު

ލ *lhaviyani*	ބ *baa*	ރ *raa*	ނ *noonu*	ޝ *shaviyani*	ހ *haa*
ދ *dhaalu*	ފ *faafu*	މ *meemu*	ވ *vaavu*	އ *alifu*	ކ *kaafu*
ގ *daviyani*	ސ *seenu*	ހ *gnaviyani*	ގ *gaafu*	ލ *laamu*	ތ *thaa*
ཆ *chaviyani*	ཇ *javiyani*	པ *paviyani*	ཡ *yaa*	ཏ *taviyani*	ཟ *zaviyani*

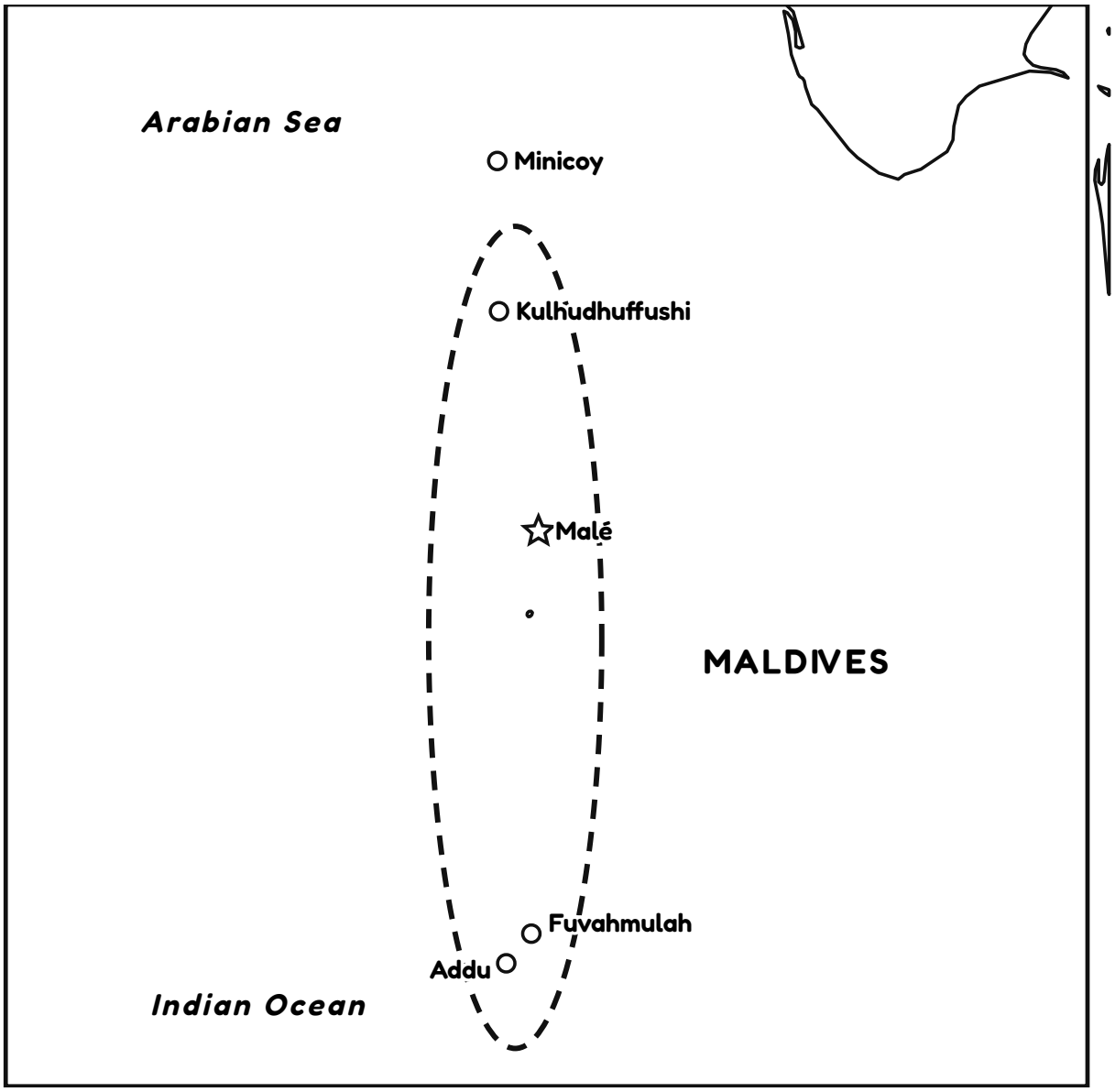
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Maldives on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Dhivehi spoken?



Color it: the sea **blue** · the land **green**. **Find it:** the Maldives are about 1,200 tiny islands inside the dashed line — most are too small to see on a map! Malé ★ is the capital. Draw little yellow islands along the chain. Dhivehi is also spoken on Minicoy island, to the north.

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THE LETTERS

The Thaana Letters ތާނަ ހަބަރު

thaana akuru — “the Thaana letters”

Dhivehi is written **from right to left**, like the Qur’an. Thaana has **24 basic letters**, and every one of them is a consonant. The vowels are small strokes called **fili** (ފިލި).

Every letter wears a fili

In a word, each letter carries a fili **above** or **below** it — or the little circle **sukun**, which means “no vowel”. In this book the big letters are shown bare so you can color them, and each letter page shows the letter with all ten fili.

بِسْ = سْ + بِ *bi + s = bis* (egg)

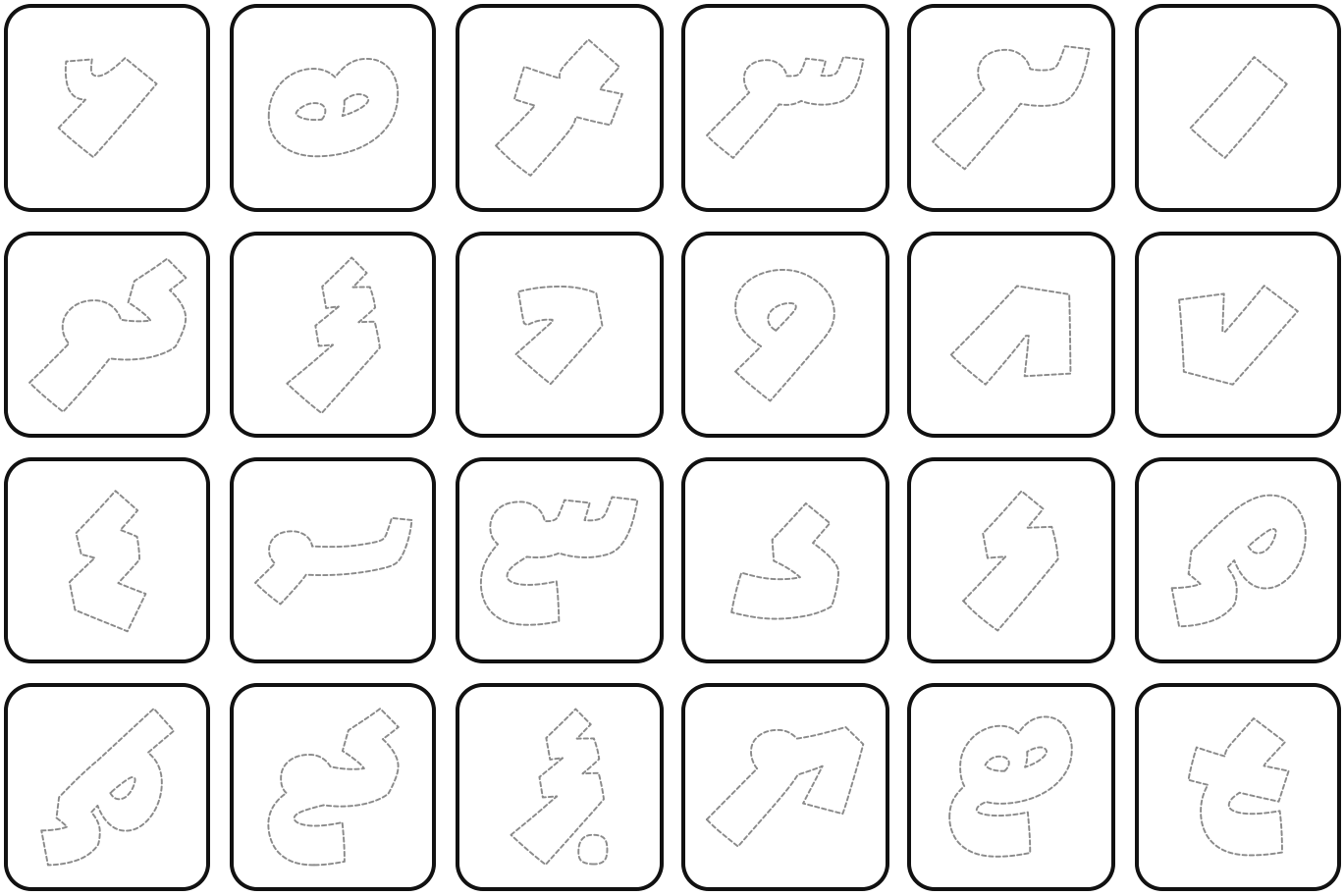
Fili name	Sound	With ބ			Start of a word
ﬠ abafili	‘a’ in “about”	ﬠ	*ba*	ﬡ	*a*
ﬠ aabaafili	‘a’ in “father”	ﬠ	*baa*	ﬡ	*aa*
ﬠ ibifili	‘i’ in “sit”	ﬠ	*bi*	ﬡ	*i*
ﬠ eebeefili	‘ee’ in “see”	ﬠ	*bee*	ﬡ	*ee*
ﬠ ubufili	‘u’ in “put”	ﬠ	*bu*	ﬡ	*u*
ﬠ ooboofili	‘oo’ in “moon”	ﬠ	*boo*	ﬡ	*oo*
ﬠ ebefili	‘e’ in “bed”	ﬠ	*be*	ﬡ	*e*
ﬠ eybeyfili	‘ey’ in “they”	ﬠ	*bey*	ﬡ	*ey*
ﬠ obofili	‘o’ in “on”	ﬠ	*bo*	ﬡ	*o*
ﬠ oaboafili	‘o’ in “go”, long	ﬠ	*boa*	ﬡ	*oa*
ﬠ sukun	no vowel	ﬠ	*b*	ﬡ	doubles the next letter

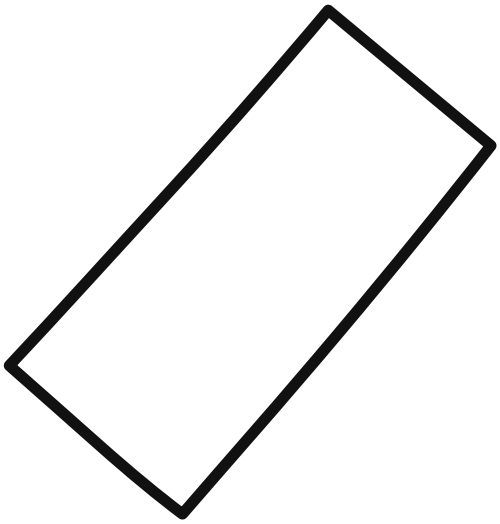
A vowel at the start of a word sits on ﬡ *alifu*, which has no sound of its own: ﬡ ﬢ ﬣ *anbu* (mango).

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters ڤۆسۆ ھەبۇغ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ނަންމަ

ހ

haa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ހ ُ	ހ ِ	ހ ِ	ހ ָ	ހ ַ
hu	hee	hi	haa	ha
ހ ُ	ހ ֹ	ހ ֶ	ހ ֵ	ހ ֳ
hoa	ho	hey	he	hoo



ހ IS FOR

ހުނަރު

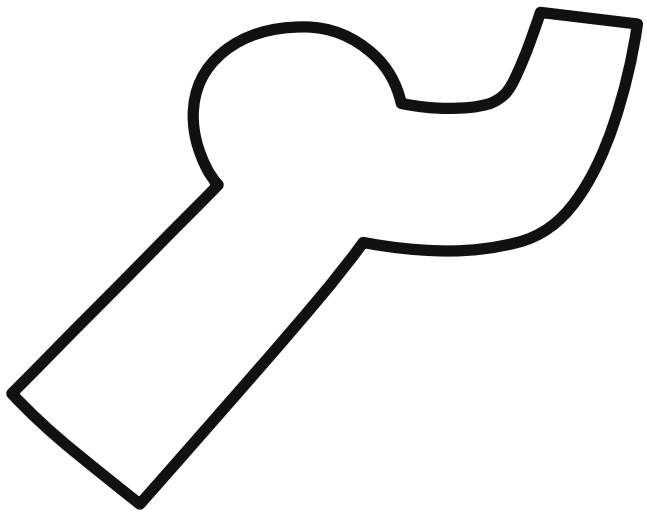
handhu

the moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

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NAME · ނަން

ށަވިޔަނި

shaviyani

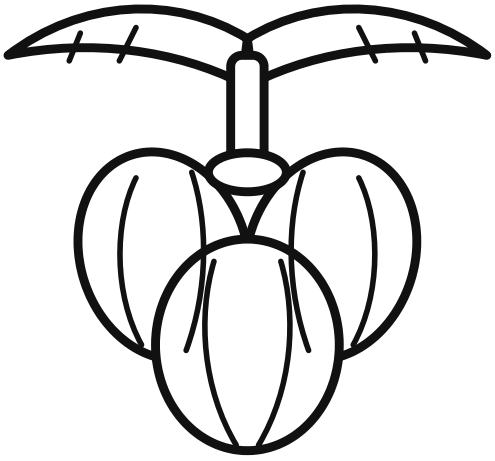
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “shoe” — but at the end of a word (ްށ) it says ‘h’

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ށ	ށ	ށ	ށ	ށ
shu	shee	shi	shaa	sha
ށ	ށ	ށ	ށ	ށ
shoa	sho	shey	she	shoo

Find ށ inside ށާ — it hardly ever starts a word.



ށ IS FOR

ށާ

kaashi

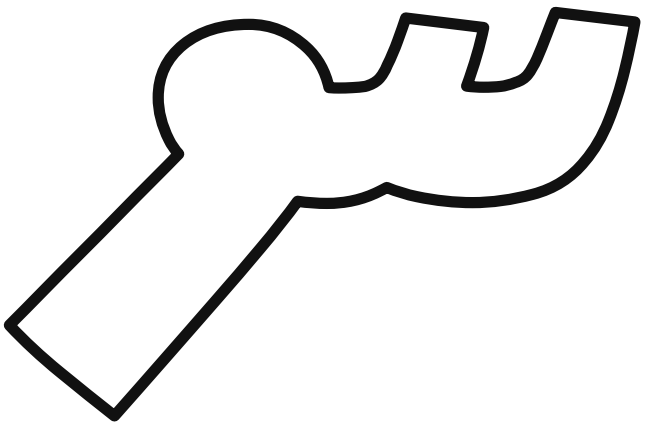
coconut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ފުރާ

ށ ށ ށ ށ

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NAME · ނޫނު

ނޫނު

noonu

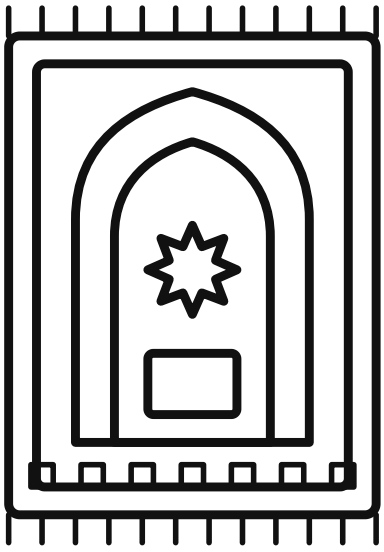
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net"

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ނު	ނޭ	ނި	ނާ	ނަ
nu	nee	ni	naa	na
ނ	ނ	ނ	ނ	ނ
noa	no	ney	ne	noo

With no fili, ނ glides into the next letter: *ހަނ*ދުނ *handhu*, *ހ*ަނ*ދ*ު *anbu*.



ނ IS FOR

ނަމާދު

namaadhu

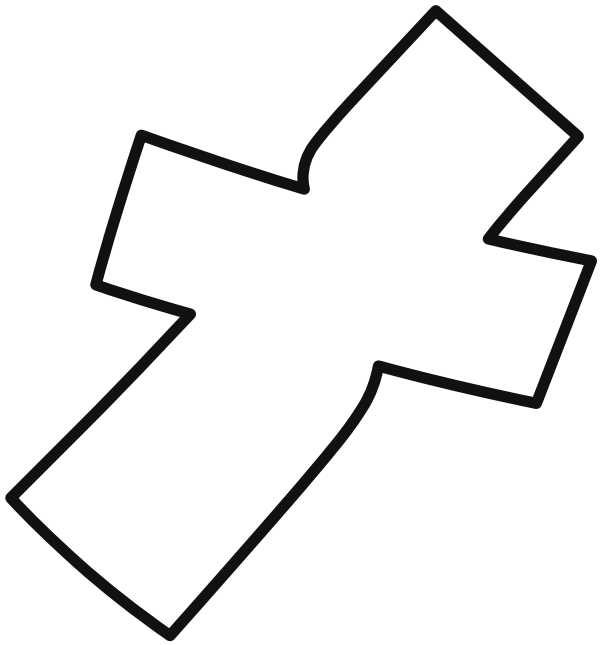
prayer (salah)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ތ ڑ ؤ

ނ ނ ނ ނ

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NAME · ނަރުނާ

ށ

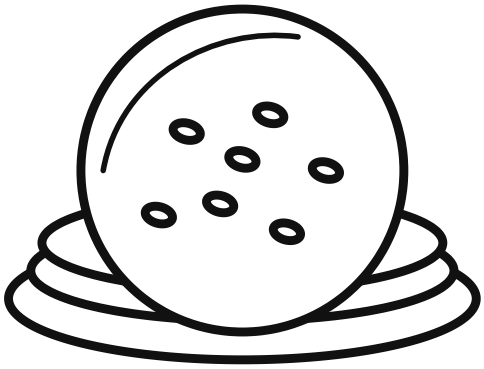
raa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ށ ُ ru	ށ ٔ ree	ށ ِ ri	ށ ٓ raa	ށ ַ ra
ށ ۦ roa	ށ ۥ ro	ށ ۧ rey	ށ ۦ re	ށ ۥ roo



ށ IS FOR

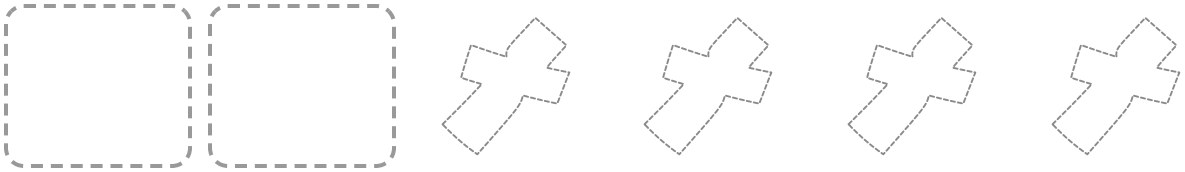


roshi

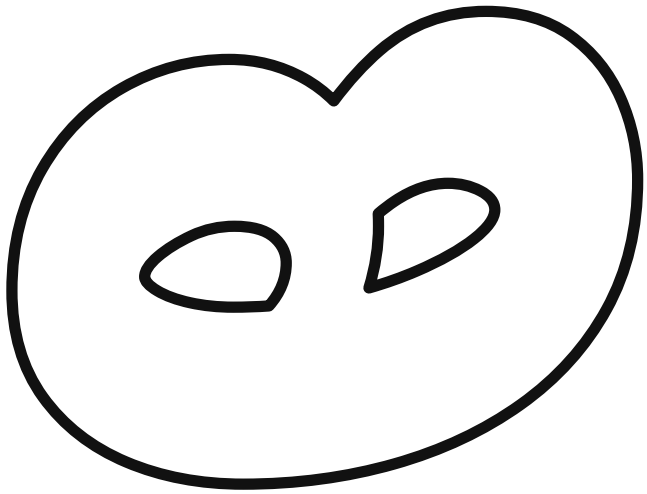
flatbread (roshi)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ވަކިވާ



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NAME · ނަންސް

ބ

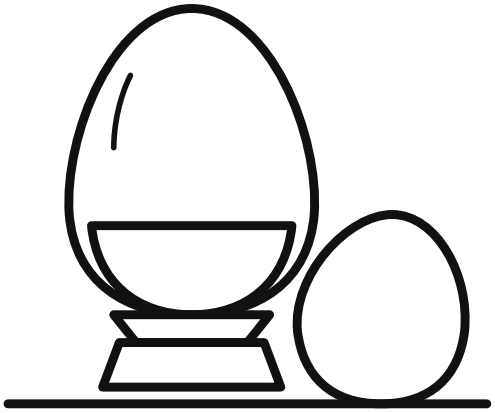
baa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ބ ُ	ބ ٓ	ބ ِ	ބ ّ	ބ َ
bu	bee	bi	baa	ba
ބ ٗ	ބ ٞ	ބ ٔ	ބ ٙ	ބ ٚ
boa	bo	bey	be	boo



ބ IS FOR

ބ ِ ހ ް ނ ު

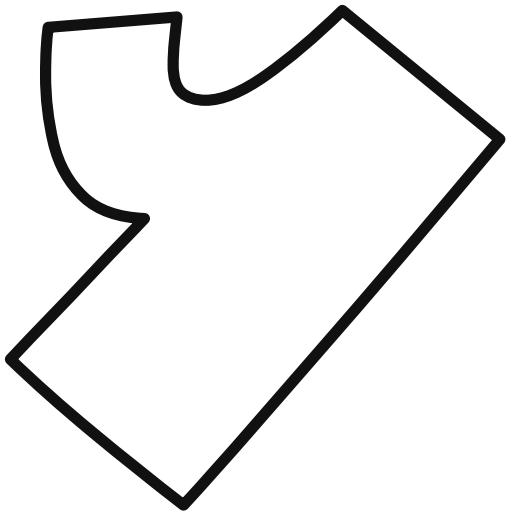
bis

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ތ ر ؤ ً

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NAME · ނަން

ލަވިޔަނި

lhaviyani

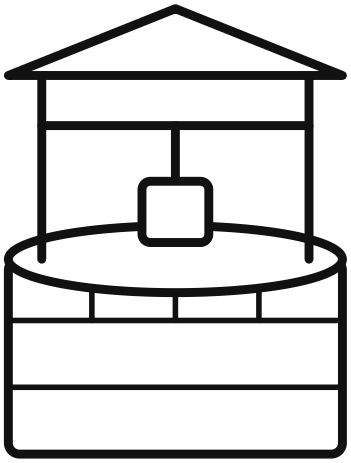
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

an ‘l’ with the tongue curled back — written ‘lh’

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ލ ް	ލ ެ	ލ ި	ލ ާ	ލ
lhu	lhee	lhi	lhaa	lha
ލ ޮ	ލ ޭ	ލ ެ ް	ލ ޯ	ލ ް
lhoa	lho	lhey	lhe	lhoo

Find ލ inside ވ ް ލ — it hardly ever starts a word.



ލ IS FOR

ވ ް ލ

valhu

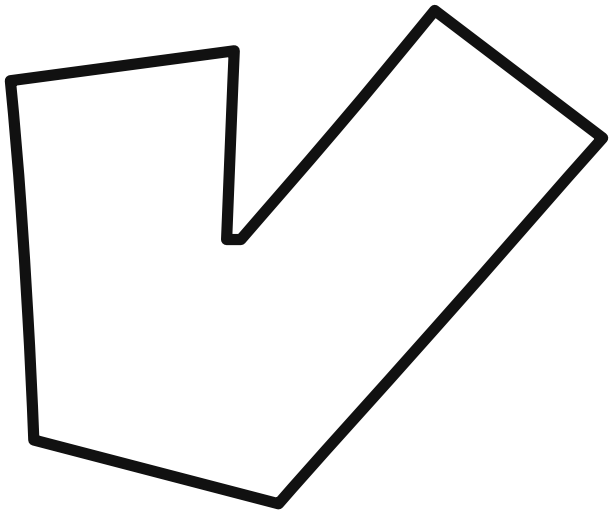
well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ވ ް ލ ު

ލ ލ ލ ލ

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NAME · ނަން

ކ

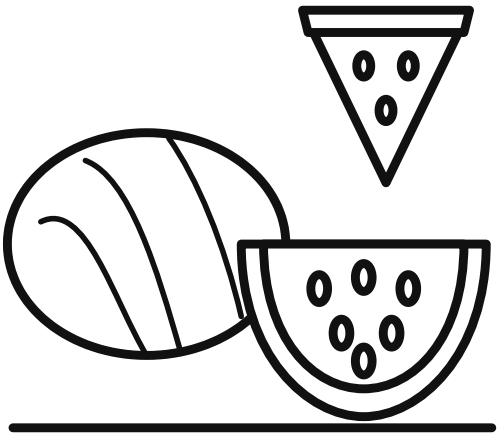
kaafu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ކ ु	ku	ކ ी	kee	ki
ک	kaa	ک ́	ka	
ک ॅ	koa	ک ॆ	ko	
ک े	key	ک ै	ke	
ک ॊ	koo			



ک IS FOR

ک ́

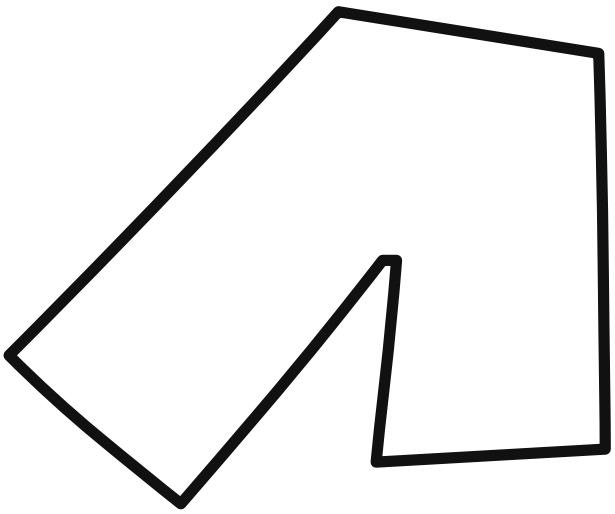
karaa

watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔާ

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NAME · ނަން

ތ ައ ލ ިފ ު

alifu

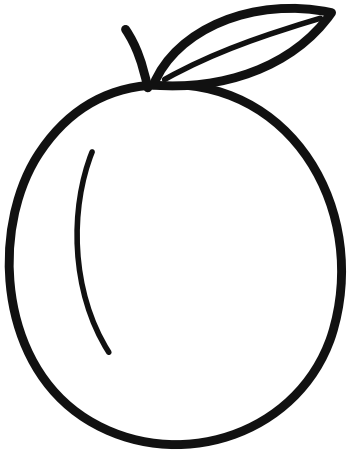
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

no sound of its own — it carries the vowel at the start of a word

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް
u	ee	i	aa	a
ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް	ތ ައ ލ ް
oa	o	ey	e	oo

ައ = *a*, *ައ* = *aa*. With sukun (*ައ*) it doubles the next letter.



ތ IS FOR

ތ ަ ނ ް ބ ު

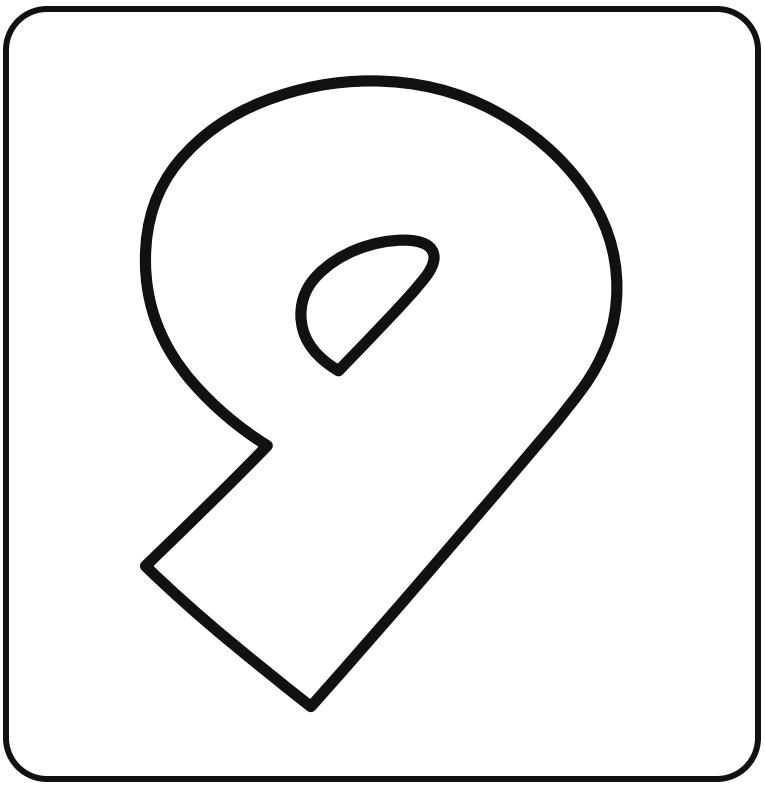
anbu

mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

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NAME · ނަންގ

ވ ◌ް ◌ާ ◌ު

vaavu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

between ‘v’ and ‘w’

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

◌ް	◌ާ	◌ި	◌ު	◌ަ
vu	vee	vi	vaa	va
◌ް	◌ާ	◌ި	◌ު	◌ަ
voa	vo	vey	ve	voo



ވ IS FOR

ވ◌ާ ◌ި

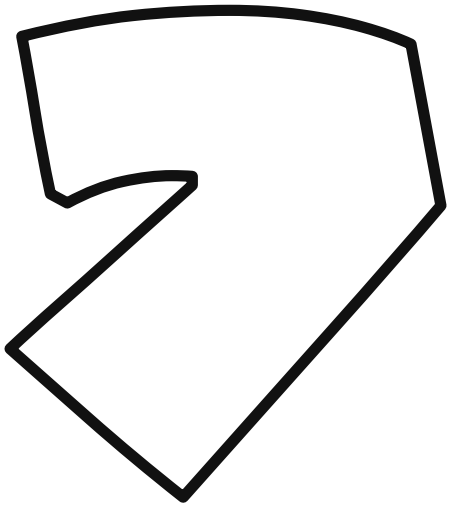
vaarey

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

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NAME · ނަންމަ

ﻣ

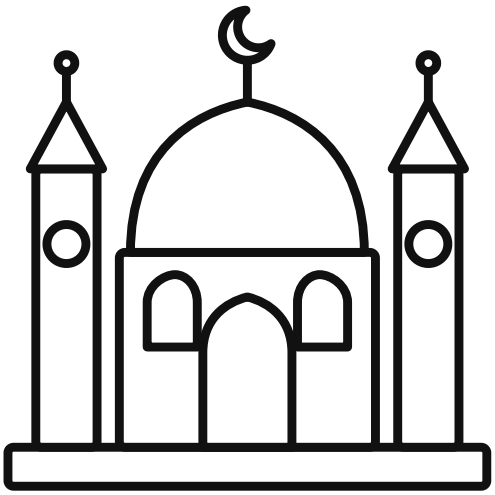
meemu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ﻣُ	ﻣِ	ﻣَ	ﻣَا	ﻣ
mu	mee	mi	maa	ma
ﻣ	ﻣ	ﻣ	ﻣ	ﻣ
moa	mo	mey	me	moo



ﷺ IS FOR

ﻣ ﺳ ﮐ ﻳ

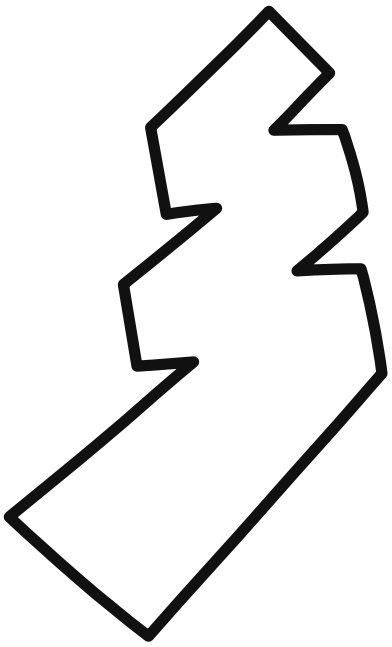
miskiy

mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ،ﺗ ،ﺮ ،ﻮ

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NAME · ނަންފަ

ފ

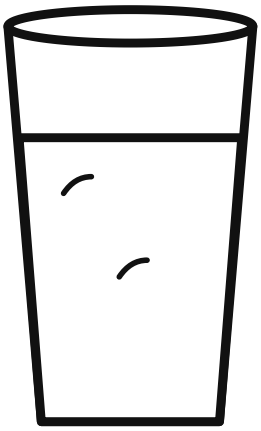
faafu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ފ ު	ފ ޫ	ފ ި	ފ ާ	ފ ަ
fu	fee	fi	faa	fa
ފ ޮ	ފ ޯ	ފ ެ	ފ ේ	ފ ෝ
foa	fo	fey	fe	foo



ފ IS FOR

ފޮށި

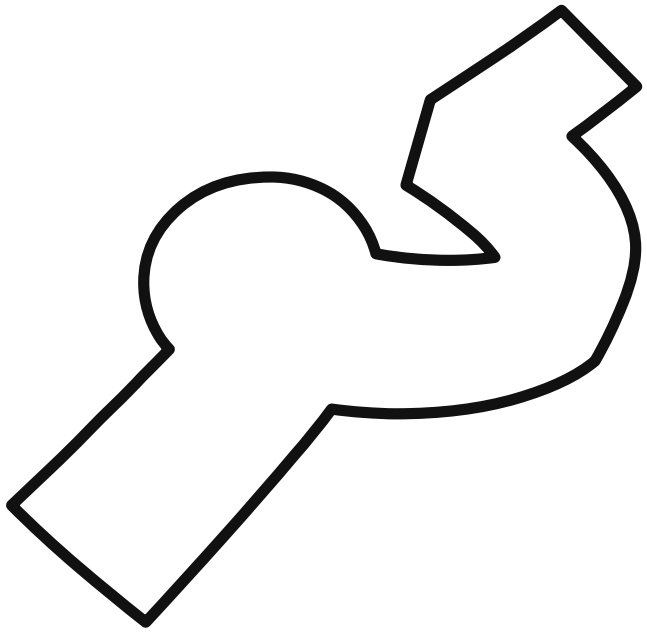
fen

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ފާތިހާ

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NAME · ނަންގ

ދ

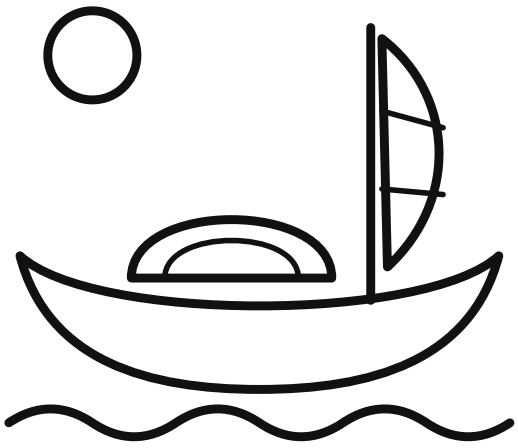
dhaalu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth (written ‘dh’)

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ދު dhu	ދޫ dhee	ދި dhi	ދާ dhaa	ދަ dha
ދޮ dhoa	ދޯ dho	ދޭ dhey	ދެ dhe	ދޫ dhoo



ދ IS FOR

ދޯނި

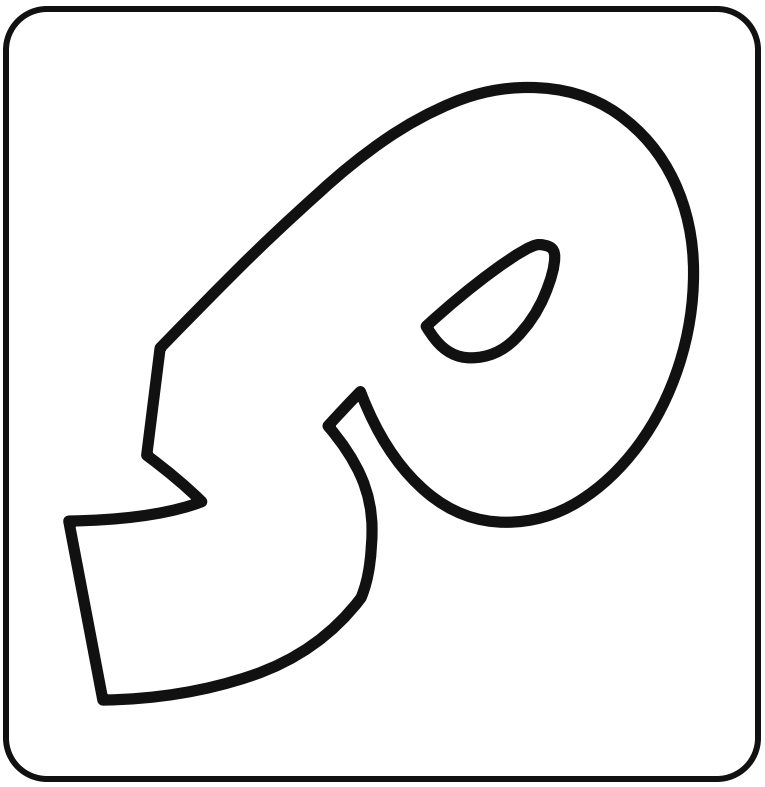
dhoani

dhoni, a Maldivian boat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ދ ؤ

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NAME · ނަން

ތ

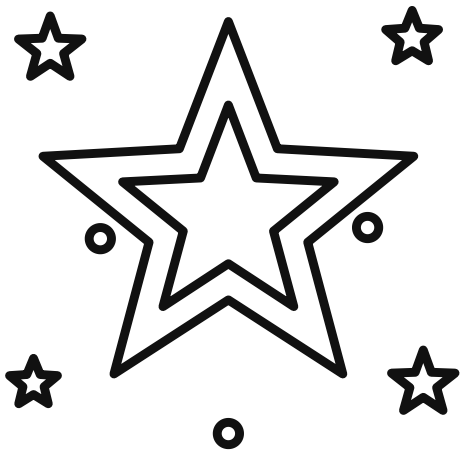
thaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth (written ‘th’, not English “th”)

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ތު	ތޫ	ތި	ތާ	ތަ
thu	thee	thi	thaa	tha
ތ ް	ތ ް	ތ ް	ތ ް	ތ ް
thoa	tho	they	the	thoo



ތ IS FOR

ތާރި

thari

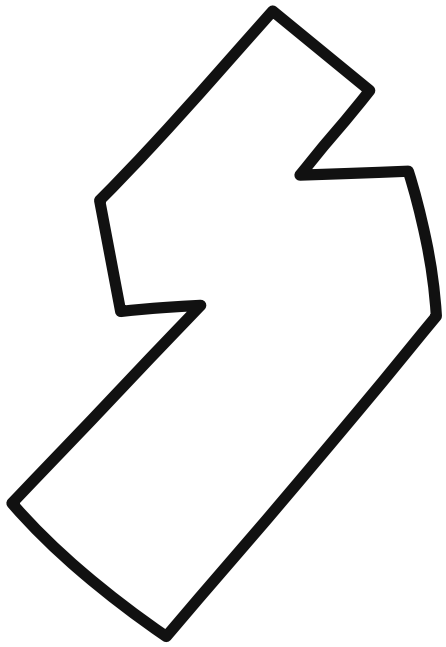
star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ތ ތ ތ ތ

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NAME · ނަންމަ

ލާ

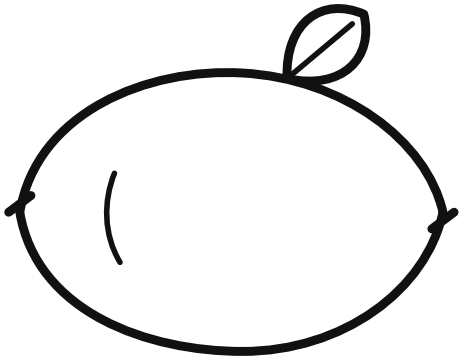
laamu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ލ ު	ލ ූ	ލ ි	ලා	ල
lu	lee	li	laa	la
ලෝ	ලෙ	ලේ	ලෛ	ලෞ
loa	lo	ley	le	loo



ލ IS FOR

ލުންބޮ

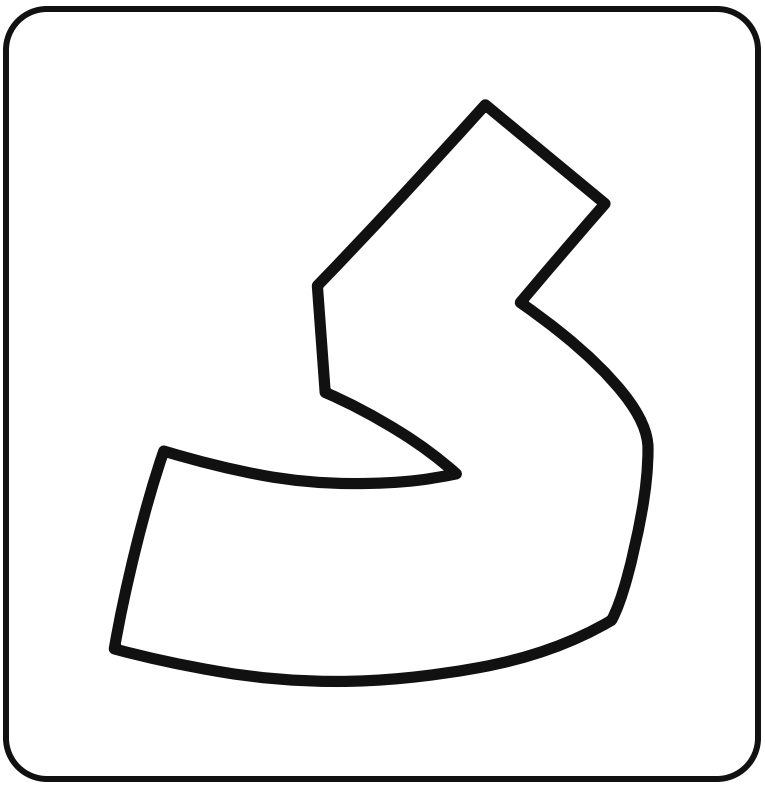
lunboa

lime

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިއްޓާ

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NAME · ނަން

ގާފު

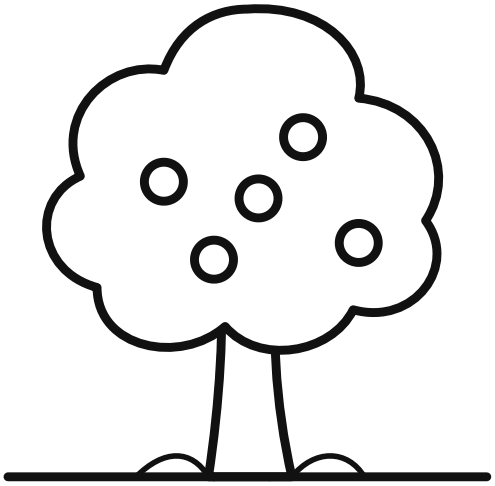
gaafu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ގ ُ	ގ ٍ	ގ ִ	ގ ָ	ގ َ
gu	gee	gi	gaa	ga
ގ ٗ	ގ ٚ	ގ ٜ	ގ ٖ	ގ ٙ
goa	go	gey	ge	goo



ގ IS FOR

ގަހު

gas

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ގ ގ ގ ގ

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ށ

NAME · ނަން

ށ ގ ވ ި ޔ ަ ނ ީ

gnaviyani

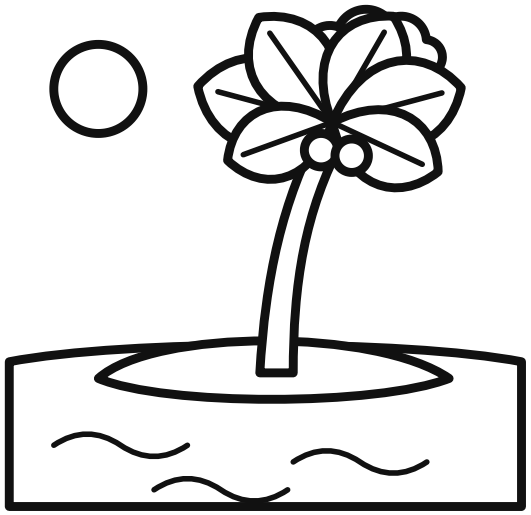
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ny' as in "canyon" — a rare old letter

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ށ ު	ށ ެ	ށ ި	ށ ާ	ށ
gnu	gnee	gni	gnaa	gna
ށ ް	ށ ް ޚ	ށ ް ؘ	ށ ް ؚ	ށ ް ؙ
gnoa	gno	gney	gne	gnoo

ށ is hardly used in words today, but a whole atoll, the island of Fuvahmulah, carries its name!



ށ IS FOR

ށ ގ ވ ި ޔ ަ ނ ީ ތ ޮ ޅ ު

gnaviyani atholhu

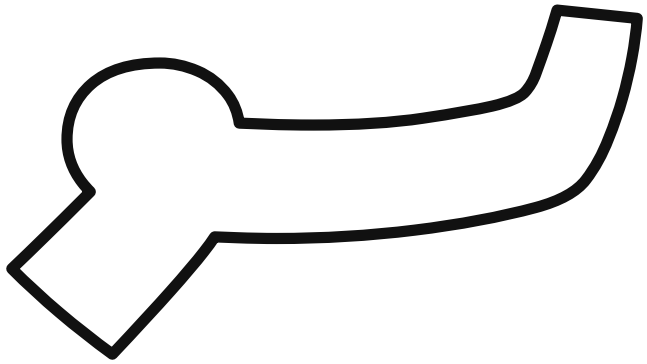
Gnaviyani Atoll (Fuvahmulah island)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ށ ށ ށ ށ

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NAME · ނަންނު

ސީނު

seenu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ސު	ސީ	ސި	ސާ	ސަ
su	see	si	saa	sa
ސ ۊ	ސ ۏ	ސ ۑ	ސ ۓ	ސ ے
soa	so	sey	se	soo



ސ IS FOR

ސޭ

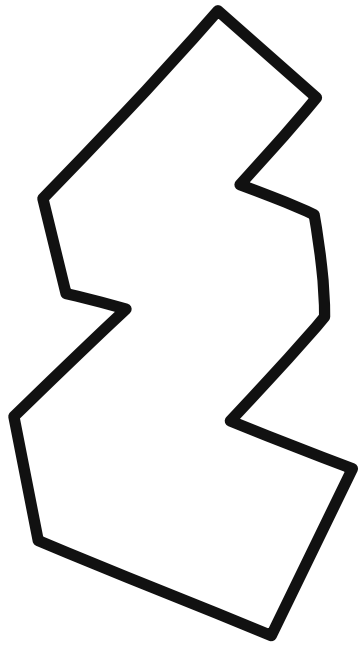
sai

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ތްރޭ

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NAME · ނަން

ދ ވ ިޔ ަ ނ ި

daviyani

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back (written ‘d’)

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ދ ް	ދ ީ	ދ ި	ދ ާ	ދ
du	dee	di	daa	da
ދ ޮ	ދ ެ	ދ ේ	ދ ේ	ދ ෝ
doa	do	dey	de	doo

Find ދ inside ނ ަ ސ ް ރ ެ އ ް — it hardly ever starts a word.



ދ IS FOR

ނ ަ ސ ް ރ ެ އ ް

handoo

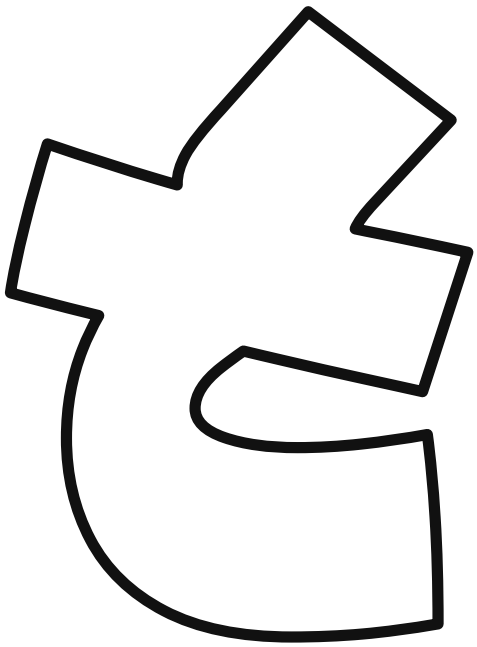
rice (grains)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލ ިޔ ެ ފ ި

ދ ދ ދ ދ

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NAME · ނަން

ޒަވިޔަނި

zaviyani

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'z' as in "zoo" — mostly in words from Arabic

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ޒ ُ	ޒ ٖ	ޒ ِ	ޒ ٓ	ޒ َ
zu	zee	zi	zaa	za
ޒ ۥ	ޒ ٗ	ޒ ٔ	ޒ ٕ	ޒ ٙ
zoa	zo	zey	ze	zoo



ޒ IS FOR

ޒަމްޒަމް

zamzam

Zamzam water from Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ޒ ޒ ޒ ޒ

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ﷺ

NAME · ނަން

ތ ާ ވ ި ޔ ަ ނ ި

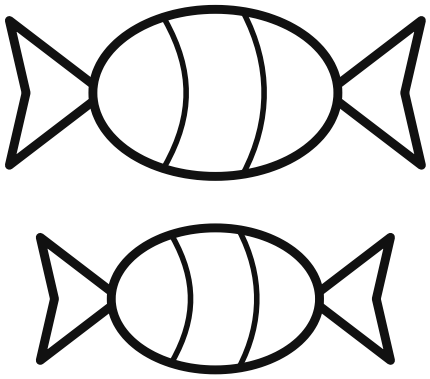
taviyani

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back (written ‘t’)

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ތ ު	ތ ޫ	ތ ި	ތ ާ	ތ ަ
tu	tee	ti	taa	ta
ތ ޮ	ތ ޯ	ތ ެ	ތ ේ	ތ ෝ
toa	to	tey	te	too



ތ IS FOR

ތ ޮ ފ ީ

tofee

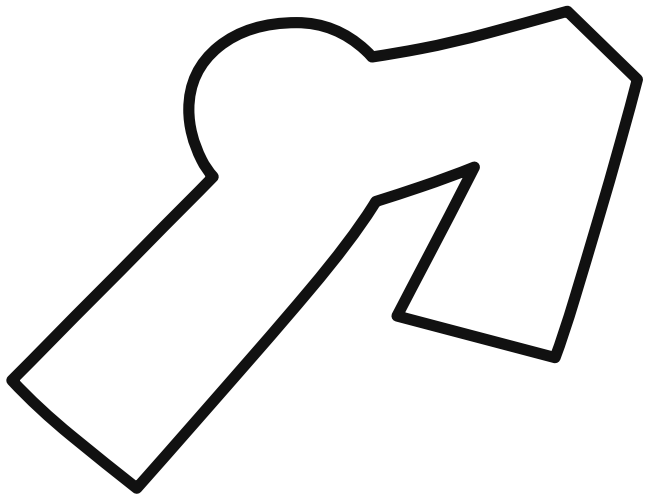
toffee, a sweet

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ﷺ ﷺ ﷺ ﷺ

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NAME · ނަން

ﯼ

yaa

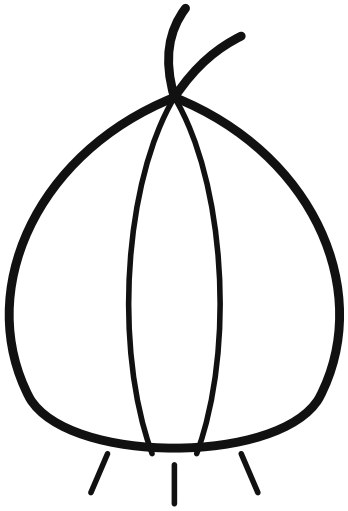
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ﯼ ُ	ﯼ ِ	ﯼ ِ	ﯼ ّ	ﯼ َ
yu	yee	yi	yaa	ya
ﯼ ٗ	ﯼ ٖ	ﯼ ٘	ﯼ ٙ	ﯼ ٚ
yoa	yo	yey	ye	yoo

Find ﯼ inside ﻓِﯼ — it hardly ever starts a word.



ﯼ IS FOR

ﻓِﯼ

fiyaa

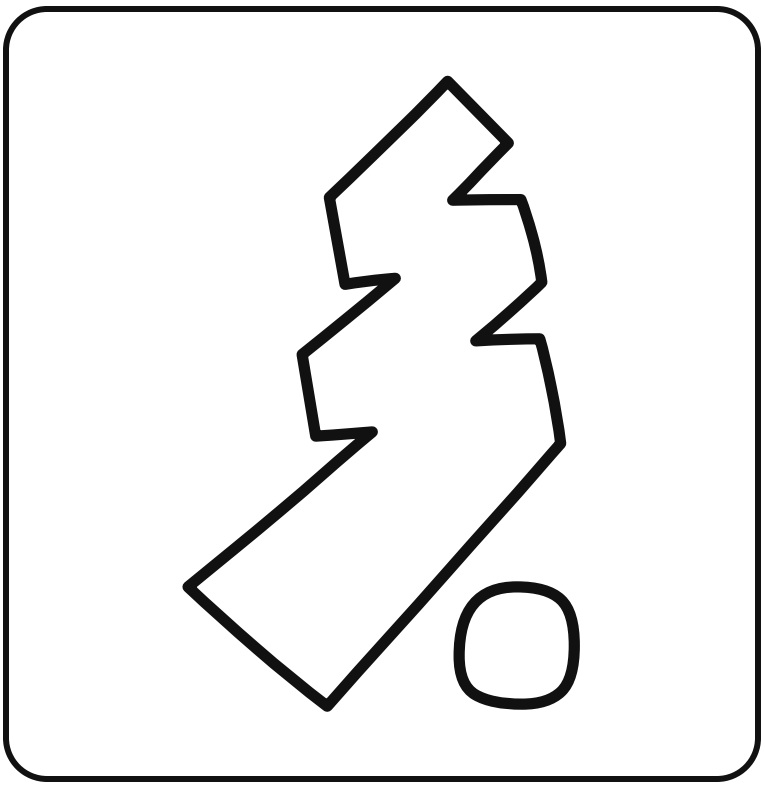
onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ﻓِﯼ

ﯼ ﯼ ﯼ ﯼ

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NAME · ނަން

ޕަވިޔަނި

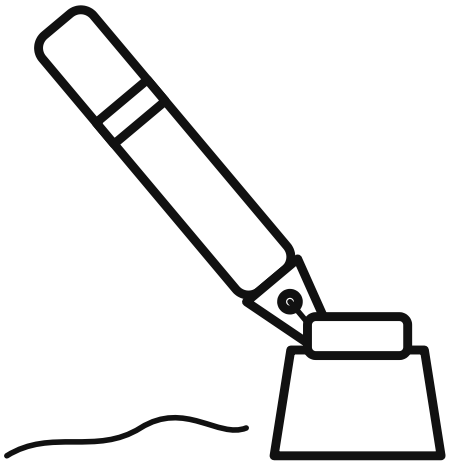
paviyani

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen” — mostly in words from English

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ޕُ	ޕُ	ޕِ	ޕָ	ޕַ
pu	pee	pi	paa	pa
ޕ	ޕ	ޕ	ޕ	ޕ
poa	po	pey	pe	poo



ޕ IS FOR

ޕެން

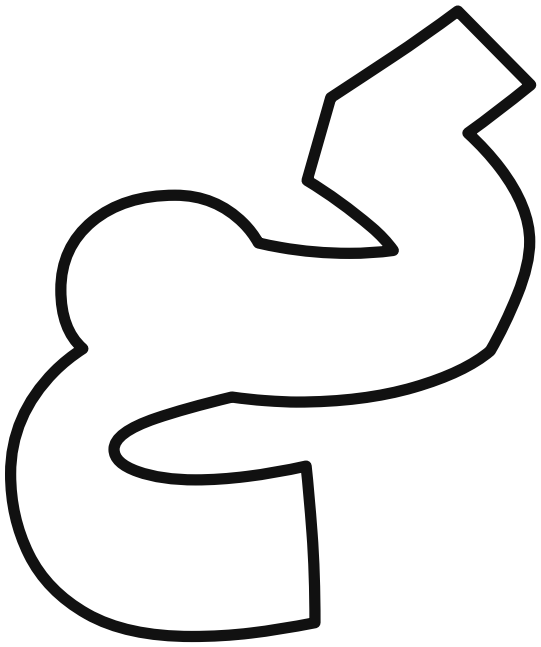
pen

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

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NAME · ނަން

ޖަވިޔަނި

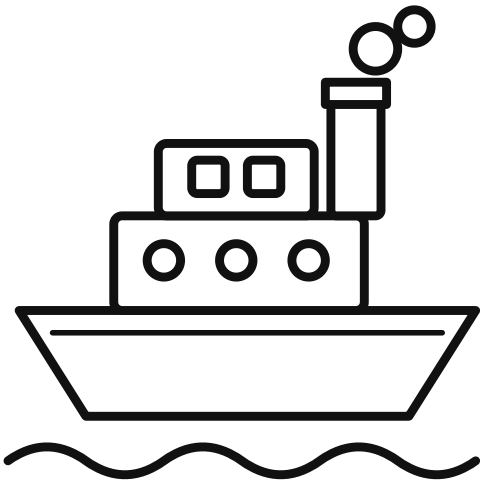
javiyani

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ja	jaa	ji	jee	ju
ޖަ	ޖާ	ޖި	ޖީ	ޖު
joo	**je**	**jey**	**jo**	**joa**
ޜޫ	ޜެ	ޜޭ	ޜོ	ޜོ



ޖ IS FOR

ޖަޒާއު

jahaazu

ship

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ޖ ޖ ޖ ޖ

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ﭺ

NAME · ނަން

ﭼ ﮪ ﮨ ﮩ ﮯ

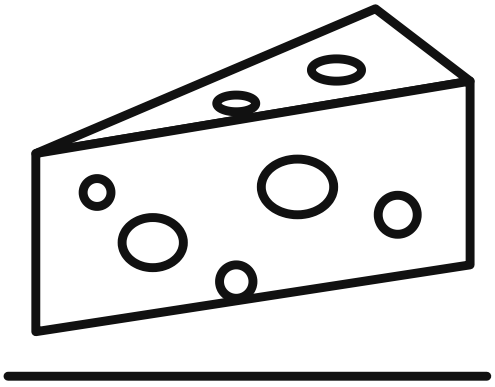
chaviyani

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

ﭺ ﮫ	ﭺ ﮬ	ﭺ ﮭ	ﭺ ﮮ	ﭺ ﮯ
chu	chee	chi	chaa	cha
ﭺ ﮰ	ﭺ ﮱ	ﭺ ﮲	ﭺ ﮳	ﭺ ﮴
choa	cho	chey	che	choo



ﭺ IS FOR

ﭺ ﮭ ﮩ ﮯ

cheez

cheese

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔާ

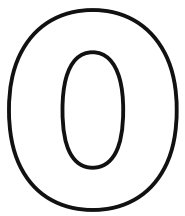
ﭺ ﭺ ﭺ ﭺ

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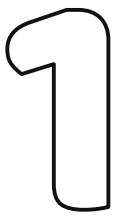
BONUS

Dhivehi numbers ތަކުތު *(adhadhu)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Dhivehi: *sumeh*, *ekeh*, *dhey*, *thineh*...



0
ސުމެއް
sumeh
zero



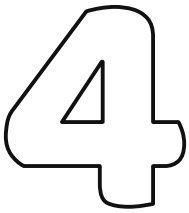
1
ހަބަ
ekeh
one



2
ދެ
dhey
two



3
ތިނެ
thineh
three



4
ހަތަރެ
hathareh
four



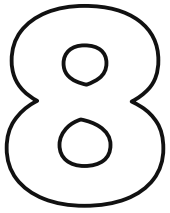
5
ފަހެ
faheh
five



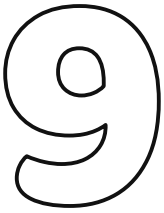
6
ހަހ
haeh
six



7
ހަތެ
hatheh
seven



8
ހަށެ
asheh
eight



9
ނުވަ
nuvaeh
nine

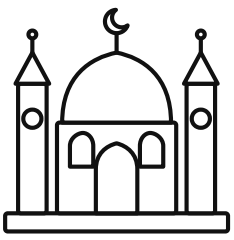
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LET'S TALK

My first Dhivehi words ފުރަތަމަ ބަސްތަކެއް

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ﷺ	*assalaamu alaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
وَعَلَيْكُمُ السَّلَامُ	*va alaikum assalaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
... ގަނޑުގެ ނަމަކީ	*aharenge namakee ...* **My name is ...**
شُكْرِيًّا	*shukuriyyaa* **Thank you**
جَزَاكَ اللهُ خَيْرًا	*jazaakallaahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
ދާދި · ބައްޕަ	*manma · bappa* **Mother · Father**
ބޭބެ · ދަތްތަ	*beybe · dhaththa* **Big brother · Big sister**
ހާ · ނޫން	*aan · noon* **Yes · No**
ގަނޑުގެ ދިވެހި ބަސް ދަސްކުރަމުން ދަނީ!	*aharen dhivehi bas dhaskuramun dhanee!* **I am learning Dhivehi!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

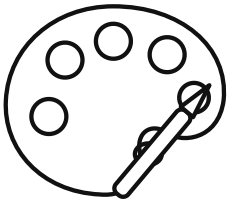
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); the history of the Thaana letters from standard reference works on the script.

What's next?
You have met all **24 Dhivehi letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Dhivehi, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ދެށްوالله! ވަތަކުރ ތަނަވަސް!

maashaallaah! varah rangalhu! — Well done, very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 24 letters of the Dhivehi alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.